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DDS MARINE WEEKLY

MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

T A N K E R S | E N E R G Y | S T S | C O M P L I A N C E

Insight. Safety. Excellence.

ISSUE 006

4 SEPTEMBER 2026

Published by DDS Maritime Intelligence

A Research & Market Intelligence Publication of DDS Marine Energy Services

• Malaysia / Southeast Asia Focus — Prepared for Professional Circulation •



Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: 3–4 September 2026 | oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News, Reuters/RFE/RL/NPR/CBS and market fixture reports

BRENT CRUDE

US\$94.86/bbl

▲ from US\$88.57 in Issue 005

WTI CRUDE

US\$90.72/bbl

▲ from US\$82.25 in Issue 005

SINGAPORE VLSFO

US\$838.00/mt

▲ US\$25.50 d/d; +US\$68 since 27 Aug

HORMUZ TRANSITS (KPLER)

5 vessels

▼ vs. officials' claim of ~40

WAR-RISK PREMIUM

3–6%+

▲ of vessel value, Gulf transits

IRAN BLACKLISTED TANKERS

45 vessels

▲ incl. ADNOC L&S, Navig8, Bahri-linked

DDS VIEW — The pause we reported in Issue 005 is over. On 30 August the US struck two Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island, saying IRGC forces were preparing to fire rockets carrying sea mines into the Strait — the first direct US strike on Iranian positions in over a month. Iran retaliated within hours, firing ballistic missiles at US-linked bases in Jordan and at an airbase in the UAE. By 31 August the supertanker **Senegal Prosperity** (Liberia-flagged, South Korean-owned) had been struck by two naval mines and caught fire inside the “safe” southern corridor the US Navy patrols, and the **Sidr** was hit by projectiles the same day. UKMTO has since logged a further projectile attack on a tanker off Khasab. Separately, Iran’s newly created Persian Gulf Strait Authority has blacklisted 45 tankers — including vessels linked to ADNOC Logistics & Services, its Navig8 Tankers subsidiary, and Saudi Arabia’s Bahri — and has now extended the threat to any vessel conducting STS transfers with a listed ship. Most strikingly, the credibility gap between official and tracked data has widened further: US officials describe escorting some 40 vessels carrying 18 million barrels through the Strait on a single day this week, while Kpler’s independently tracked count shows just five commodity vessels transiting on Monday — and zero liquid tankers among them. Brent has responded accordingly, up from US\$88.57 to US\$94.86 since our last issue.

This Week at a Glance

- **Escalation:** US struck Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island (30 Aug); Iran retaliated with missiles against US-linked bases in Jordan and the UAE — the first major exchange in over a month.
- **Tanker attacks:** Supertanker **Senegal Prosperity** struck by naval mines and set on fire (31 Aug); **Sidr** hit by projectiles same day; a further tanker struck by projectiles off Khasab this week.
- **Credibility gap:** US officials describe a “wartime high” of ~40 vessels/18m bbl escorted through Hormuz in a day; Kpler’s tracked count shows just 5 vessels on Monday, well below the 10-day average of ~14.
- **Sanctions:** Iran has blacklisted 45 tankers — including vessels linked to ADNOC L&S, Navig8 and Bahri — and threatens to extend penalties to any vessel conducting STS transfers with them.
- **Oil & freight:** Brent US\$94.86/bbl, WTI US\$90.72/bbl, both up sharply since Larak; tanker freight remains firm-to-rising per this week’s fixture reports despite the lower confirmed physical flow.
- **Period market:** BP and ST Shipping have each committed tonnage on 3–5-year time charters at today’s elevated rates — a signal some charterers expect firmer freight to outlast the current crisis (see Freight & Rate Signals).

“ CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

“Believe the tracker, not the transcript. That gap is the whole story this week.”

Issue 005 recorded the first tentative steps toward de-escalation. That window has closed. On 30 August the US struck Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island, and within hours Iran had fired ballistic missiles at US-linked bases in Jordan and the UAE. By the next day a supertanker had been holed by naval mines inside the corridor the US Navy calls safe, and a second vessel had been hit by projectiles. A third tanker was struck off Khasab days later. This is not a de-escalation story. It is the sharpest exchange we have recorded since we began this publication.

What I want every reader to sit with is not the violence alone but the arithmetic around it. US officials this week described escorting roughly 40 commercial vessels carrying 18 million barrels through the Strait in a single day — a “wartime high.” Kpler’s independently tracked count for the same window shows five commodity vessels transiting on Monday, none of them liquid tankers, against a 10-day average of about 14. Both figures cannot be describing the same strait. For operators making real decisions about real tonnage, the practical lesson is to plan against the tracked number, not the announced one, until the two converge.

The second development I want to flag is closer to our own operating discipline. Iran’s newly formed Persian Gulf Strait Authority has blacklisted 45 tankers — not fringe operators, but vessels linked to ADNOC Logistics & Services, its Navig8 Tankers subsidiary, and Saudi Arabia’s Bahri. Tehran has now said any vessel conducting an STS transfer with a blacklisted ship can itself be added to the list. That is a direct, structural threat to exactly the kind of ship-to-ship operations this company runs every week. It means our counterparty screening cannot stop at the vessel in front of us; it has to extend to that vessel’s own recent transit and STS history.

My instruction to our teams: treat every Hormuz-linked nomination as an owner-level decision, screen STS counterparties against the current Iranian blacklist before every job, and build voyage economics around Kpler-tracked flows rather than official claims. This is now a live shooting conflict with a widening credibility gap at its centre, and the operators who plan around the honest number will be the ones who aren’t caught out by the next headline.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC

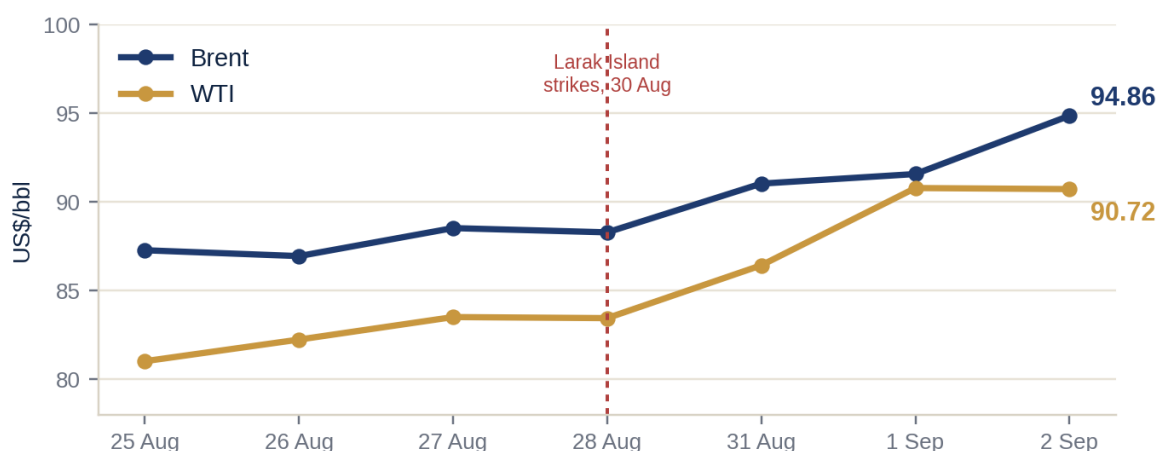
Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

Publication Principle — Independent operational commentary based on publicly available market information from oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News, wire reporting (Reuters, RFE/RL, NPR, CBS) syndicated via named outlets, and market fixture reports circulated to DDS Marine. Vessel names and incident details are published only where attributable to a named primary source.

Global Oil Market

Prices and the week's directional move, per oilprice.com and Ship & Bunker daily series

Indicator	Latest	Reading
Brent crude	US\$94.86/bbl	2 Sep close, +0.23% on the day; up ~13% over the past month as Hormuz tensions re-escalated.
WTI crude	US\$90.72/bbl	2 Sep close; up from US\$83.44 a week earlier as the Larak Island strikes repriced supply risk.
Brent 25 Aug–2 Sep range	US\$86.94–94.86/bbl	Seven-session range; the rally accelerated sharply after 30 August.



Source: Ship & Bunker daily close series and oilprice.com/Trading Economics live indications, 25 Aug–2 Sep 2026.

Market Interpretation

Oil has moved decisively higher since our last issue. Brent gained roughly 5% in a single session on 1 September — its sharpest one-day move since late July — after the US struck Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island and Iran retaliated against US-linked bases in Jordan and the UAE. The rally has continued through the week, with Brent closing at US\$94.86/bbl on 2 September, its highest level since late July, and WTI at US\$90.72/bbl.

As in previous issues, the price move is running well ahead of any change in confirmed physical flows. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Energy Secretary Chris Wright have both pointed to high headline volumes moving through Hormuz this week (as much as 17–18 million barrels on a single day), while Kpler's vessel-tracking data shows a far thinner picture — see Geopolitical & Route Risk, overleaf, for the full comparison. That gap between claimed and tracked volumes is itself now a market-moving variable.

DDS BASE CASE — With active kinetic exchanges resumed and no negotiating framework in place, we see Brent holding in a US\$90–100/bbl range with sharp upside risk on any further strike, mining incident or escalation toward Kharg Island. A reversion to the high-US\$80s would require a de-escalation neither side has signalled.

Commercial effect on shipping: Bunker costs have risen in step with crude this week (see Bunker Market, p.7). Owners should treat any voyage budget built before 30 August as stale, and re-price war-risk, deviation and STS screening costs against the current environment rather than last month's assumptions.



Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax — indicative ranges from market fixture reports, week of 1 September 2026

Methodology note: No Baltic Exchange TD/TC print was available to DDS for this issue. Consistent with standard market practice, freight levels below are presented as **ranges** drawn from circulated fixture and market reports, not single fixed figures.

Segment	Current Tone	Indicative Range
VLCC	Very firm; fixtures clearing quickly “on subs”	Fujairah loadings Ws235–245; strong owner-side interest MEG and West Africa
Suezmax	Firm, Gulf routes untested at top end	WAF/East Ws245–250; CPC/Med-UKC-Ningbo Ws340–350 (~US\$17m lump sum)
Aframax	Firm across Gulf-linked routes	Fuj/East Ws330–340; AG/East Ws500+ (basis owners' willingness, largely untested)

VLCC

The Middle East Gulf VLCC list was active this week, with multiple fixtures reported on subjects rather than confirmed rates: Morning Hope, Pinios, Zakum, Hercules I and Advantage Verity all fixed Fujairah loadings between 3 and 8 September on subs. Front Eira fixed Fujairah/East at Ws242.5 (270k) — one of the few confirmed levels this week — while Petraco covered 235k tonnes on similar terms. Outstanding cargo interest remains broad, spanning Qatar Energy, ST Shipping, Vitol, IOC, HPCL, Trafigura and Mercuria across both Middle East Gulf and US Gulf loadings into October.

Suezmax

West African and Black Sea/CPC routes dominated Suezmax activity. Aegean Winner fixed CPC/Med-UK Continent-Ningbo at Ws350–340 (~US\$17m lump sum) for Ineos, while PTT fixed WAF/East at Ws245 for a 130k cargo. Barcelona Spirit covered an STS Malta/Rotterdam move for BP. Guyana and Angola remain active loading points, with Blue Bolt Shipping and Sonangol Maiombe both reported on UK Continent and West Coast India routings respectively.

Aframax

Aframax rates remain firm across Gulf-linked business, with Fujairah/East quoted Ws330–340 and Arabian Gulf/East business quoted Ws500 and above, though largely untested given owners' continued caution about Gulf transits.

DDS VIEW — *The pattern across all three segments this week is the same: owners are willing to quote strength, but relatively few of the highest-end levels (AG/East Aframax and Suezmax at Ws500+ and Ws700+ respectively) have actually been tested by a fixture. Treat top-of-range numbers as a ceiling on owner ambition, not a confirmed clearing level, until a fixture prints at or near that mark.*

Clean & Product Tankers

CPP rundown — Arabian Gulf, India, SE Asia and North Asia, 3 September 2026

Region	Notable Fixture	Rate
Arabian Gulf	Swarna Kamal (75k, naphtha) Oman/Japan, 12 Sep	Ws270 — Vitol, on subs
Arabian Gulf	Star Merlin (35k, jet) Kuwait/Qatar, 7–8 Sep	US\$1.65m lump sum — Qatar Energy
India	Inspiration (90k, ULSD) WCI/UK-Cont, 15–16 Sep	US\$6.5m lump sum — Reliance
Spore / Msia / Indo / Thai	Nanjing TBN (35k, CPP) Singapore/Colombo, 17 Sep	US\$1.125m lump sum — Vitol
Spore / Msia / Indo / Thai	MP MR Tanker 3 (35k, CPP) Singapore/Australia, 15 Sep	Ws330 — Shell
SKorea / Japan / USG	Nordmarlin (75k, ULSD) SKorea/Australia, 10 Sep	Ws280 — Ampol
SKorea / Japan / USG	Gordons Bay (35k, CPP) SKorea/Australia, 21–23 Sep	Ws370 — Mets

Reading the Rundown

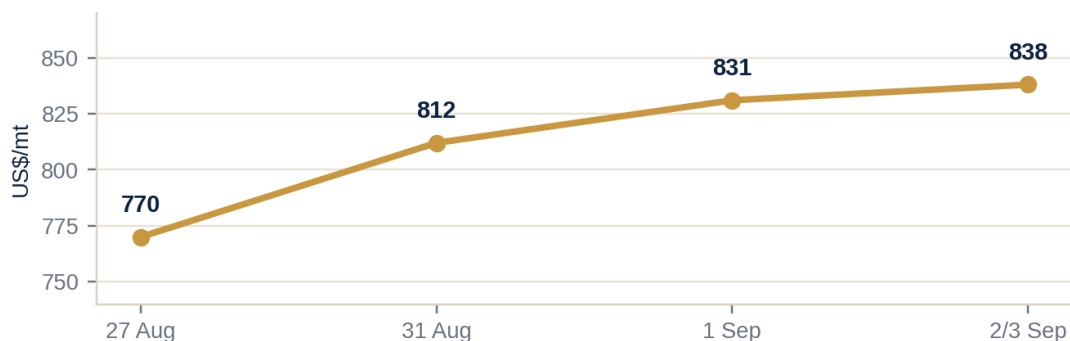
The Arabian Gulf and India legs remain the most actively quoted, with naphtha and ULSD stems continuing to clear on subs at firm levels. Our own corridor — Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand — saw steady activity this week, with Nanjing TBN's Singapore/Colombo lump-sum fixture and MP MR Tanker 3's Singapore/Australia fixture both confirming continued demand for regional CPP tonnage. North Asian business (South Korea, Japan) remains firm on Australia-bound naphtha and diesel stems, consistent with the broader premium clean tankers are commanding wherever Gulf-linked supply risk touches the routing.

DDS VIEW — *The CPP list this week shows a market still willing to fix confidently everywhere except the highest-risk Gulf-transit legs, where owners continue to quote wide and test buyer appetite rather than commit tonnage outright. For our own region's product trades, that translates into continued firm underlying demand with no signs of owners diverting MR/LR tonnage away from intra-Asia routes.*

Bunker Market — Singapore & Global Benchmark

Current indications in US\$/mt, Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 3 September 2026

Grade	Singapore	Day Change
VLSFO	US\$838.00/mt	+US\$25.50
MGO	US\$1,222.50/mt	+US\$30.00
IFO380	US\$642.50/mt	+US\$3.00



Singapore VLSFO, US\$/mt, 27 Aug – 3 Sep 2026. Source: Ship & Bunker and market reports.

Interpretation

Bunker prices have risen sharply since our last issue, tracking the crude rally step for step. Singapore VLSFO has climbed from approximately US\$770/mt on 27 August to US\$838.00/mt now — a move of roughly US\$68/mt, or almost 9%, in under a week. Fujairah VLSFO sits marginally higher at US\$844.00/mt, while Hong Kong (US\$816.00/mt) and Santos (US\$801.00/mt) have also moved up in step. Rotterdam remains the cheapest of the hubs tracked at US\$683.50/mt.

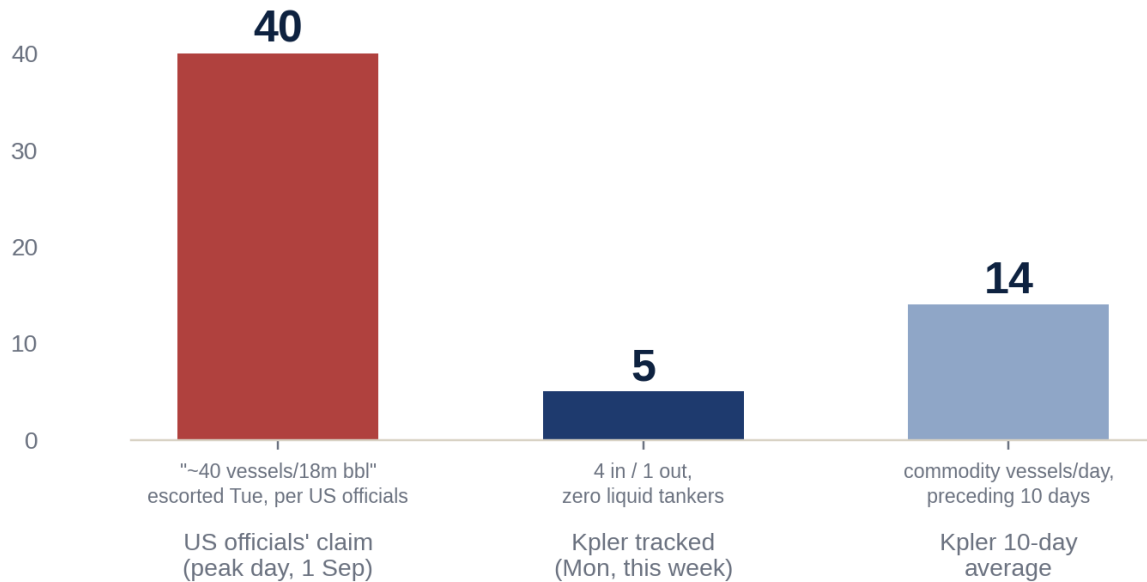
The Global 20 Ports Average VLSFO rose to US\$821.50/mt (+US\$11.00) and the Global 4 Ports Average to US\$768.00/mt (+US\$15.50). The EUA carbon price held broadly steady at €82.75 (+€0.12), with the EUA-VLSFO equivalent at US\$306.69/mt (+US\$0.48).

Compliance cost note: EU ETS compliance costs should continue to be stated explicitly in bunker and freight clauses for any EU-linked call. With bunker costs rising alongside war-risk premiums this week, owners should revisit voyage estimates built before 30 August in full, not just on the crude price line.



Geopolitical & Route Risk

Hormuz re-escalates — strikes, retaliation, and a widening gap between claimed and tracked traffic



Hormuz transit counts: officials' claims vs. Kpler-tracked data, week of 1 September 2026. Sources: US officials via Reuters/CNN; Kpler via Reuters.

Event	Detail	Commercial Consequence
Larak Island strikes	US struck two Iranian rocket launchers, 30 Aug, citing an imminent IRGC mine-laying threat. First direct US strike on Iranian positions in over a month.	Marks the end of the relative pause reported in Issue 005; risk posture reverts to active-conflict footing.
Iranian retaliation	IRGC fired ballistic missiles at US-linked bases in Jordan and at an airbase in the UAE; Jordan intercepted 8 incoming missiles.	Regional airbase and logistics risk extends beyond the Strait itself.
Senegal Prosperity	Liberia-flagged, South Korean-owned supertanker struck by two naval mines, 31 Aug, caught fire inside the US-patrolled southern corridor.	Undermines the premise that the southern corridor is meaningfully safer; see Incident Log.
Traffic credibility gap	US officials describe ~40 vessels/18m bbl escorted on 1 Sep; Kpler tracked 5 commodity vessels Monday, zero liquid tankers, 10-day average ~14.	Plan voyage and insurance economics against tracked flows, not official volume claims.

The Larak Island Exchange

US Central Command said its forces “took limited, precise action against IRGC mine-laying forces posing an imminent threat in the Strait of Hormuz,” striking two rocket launchers on Larak Island on 30 August after observing preparations to fire rockets carrying sea mines into the waterway. Iran's IRGC confirmed casualties among its personnel and vowed retaliation, which arrived within a day: ballistic missiles fired at bases housing US forces in Jordan (Jordan says it intercepted eight incoming missiles) and at an airbase in the UAE. It is the first major exchange of fire between the US and Iran in more than a month.

Tankers Caught in the Renewed Exchange

The supertanker **Senegal Prosperity** was struck by two naval mines while transiting the Strait on 31 August, sparking a fire and forcing it to stop — inside the southern corridor, close to Omani shores, that the US Navy promotes as the



strait's safe passage. The **Sidr**, another Bahri-operated vessel, was hit by projectiles the same day. UKMTO has since logged a further projectile attack on a tanker approximately 17nm east of Khasab, with an earlier vessel hit near Khasab on 29 August. CENTCOM has separately dismissed an IRGC claim of forcing a tanker to turn around without permission as "disinformation" — a reminder that claims from both sides in this conflict require independent verification wherever possible.

Believe the Tracker, Not the Transcript

The most consequential number this week may not be a price or a casualty count, but a traffic count. US officials, including Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Energy Secretary Chris Wright, have pointed to volumes as high as 17–18 million barrels moving through Hormuz on single days this week, with CNN reporting the US military escorted roughly 40 commercial vessels on Tuesday alone — a "wartime high." Kpler's independently tracked data for the same window shows just five commodity vessels transiting on Monday (four in, one out), none of them liquid tankers, against a trailing 10-day average of about 14. Some of the gap is explained by covert ship-to-ship transfers reported in the Gulf of Oman — CNN observed more than a dozen STS transfers over two days, cargo moving from southern-corridor tankers onto customer vessels waiting outside the Gulf — but the scale of the discrepancy is itself a risk signal.

DDS RISK LEVEL: CRITICAL (raised from ELEVATED in Issue 005). Active kinetic exchanges have resumed between the US and Iran; multiple tankers have been struck within the reporting window; and a material, unresolved gap exists between official and independently tracked Hormuz traffic. DDS recommends treating every Hormuz-linked nomination as an owner-level decision, obtaining current-week war-risk confirmation before fixing, and planning voyage economics against Kpler-tracked flows rather than official volume claims.



Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Developments — Week Ending 4 September 2026

Iran blacklists 45 tankers, extends threat to STS counterparties: Iran's newly established Persian Gulf Strait Authority has blacklisted 45 tankers accused of violating its Strait of Hormuz transit rules, warning that listed vessels face fines, detention and cargo confiscation. The list spans VLCCs, LNG and LPG carriers and clean-product tankers, and includes vessels linked to the United Arab Emirates' ADNOC Logistics & Services and its Navig8 Tankers subsidiary, and Saudi Arabia's national carrier Bahri — not fringe operators, but core Gulf players. Iran has said any vessel conducting an **STS transfer** with a listed vessel can itself be added to the blacklist, directly extending enforcement risk to counterparties.

War-risk insurance: Market indications this week put Gulf war-risk premiums in the region of 3–6% of vessel value for transits, with some Hormuz-specific voyages quoted materially higher. Cargo and STS cover is reported to be becoming more complex to place, consistent with insurers repricing both kinetic risk and the blacklist's counterparty-contagion effect.

Direct operational implication for DDS: the blacklist's STS-contagion clause means vessel screening can no longer stop at the nominated ship. Before accepting any STS counterparty, confirm that vessel's own recent Hormuz transit and STS history is clear of the current 45-vessel list, in addition to standard OFAC/SDN screening.

Control	Minimum Action
Iran blacklist screening	Check every nominated vessel <i>and</i> its STS counterparties against Iran's current 45-vessel list before fixing or accepting an STS job.
War-risk confirmation	Obtain current-week war-risk quotes before nominating any Hormuz-linked tonnage; do not rely on pre-30 August terms.
Transit fee position	Maintain a written, owner-level decision on Iranian transit permits/tolls; do not delegate to the master.
Riau / OPL screening	Continue enhanced due diligence at Malaysian and Indonesian outer port limits, consistent with prior reporting on deceptive-practice risk in the region.
Record preservation	Keep screenshots, reports, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file, including blacklist-check evidence.

Editorial & Verification Note: *DDS Marine Group publishes vessel names and designation detail only where attributable to a named primary source (Reuters, SAFETY4SEA, OilPrice.com and other named outlets citing the Persian Gulf Strait Authority). Readers should verify any specific vessel against the current blacklist and OFAC SDN list, and their own screening provider, before acting.*

Weekly Incident & Risk Watch

Confirmed developments, 29 August – 4 September 2026

Vessel	Flag & Type	Incident	Date
Senegal Prosperity	Liberia Supertanker	Struck by two naval mines while transiting the Strait's southern (US-patrolled) corridor. Fire broke out; vessel stopped. South Korean-owned.	31 Aug
Sidr	Bahri-operated	Struck by unknown projectiles the same day as the Senegal Prosperity incident.	31 Aug
Unnamed tanker	—	Struck by projectiles approximately 17nm east of Khasab; UKMTO confirmed, no casualties reported.	W/C 1 Sep
Unnamed tanker	—	Earlier tanker struck near Khasab.	29 Aug

Pattern assessment: Two vessels were struck within 24 hours (31 Aug) inside the corridor the US Navy specifically promotes as safe passage — a direct challenge to that assurance. CENTCOM has disputed at least one Iranian claim (of forcing a tanker to turn back) as disinformation, underscoring that both official and adversary claims in this conflict require independent verification before being relied upon operationally.

What We Are Watching

- Whether further strikes follow Trump's stated threat to extend action toward Kharg Island; NIOC says Kharg operations continue as normal for now.
- Whether Iran acts on hardline calls (Kayhan newspaper) to target subsea fibre-optic cables beneath the Gulf and the Strait.
- Whether the George Washington carrier strike group's presence changes US Navy escort posture in the southern corridor.
- P&I club and war-risk underwriter guidance following the Senegal Prosperity and Sidr incidents.

Ship Recycling & Demolition

Best Oasis's weekly report (week ending 1 Sep) describes the Indian market as firm, with buyers keen for fresh tonnage; local market conditions strengthened after enforcement action against cash-based scrap transactions outside the formal GST framework pushed more demand into GST-compliant channels. Bangladesh softened slightly at the local level, though demand remains present. Pakistan remains healthy but saw some correction after the previous week's sharp increase. Türkiye was broadly unchanged. Separately, Intermodal reports recycling markets “broadly healthy, but a shortage of available tonnage continues to constrain activity,” with owners deferring scrapping decisions to capture the currently firm freight market — consistent with what we are seeing across the tanker segments this issue.



Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam — the Malacca-to-Pengerang corridor

This week's Gulf of Oman developments carry a direct lesson for our own operations. CNN reported observing more than a dozen ship-to-ship transfers in the Gulf of Oman over two days — tankers backed by the US Navy moving cargo from the southern corridor onto customer vessels waiting outside the Strait. That pattern of STS-based volume laundering, whatever its purpose in the Gulf, sits inside exactly the kind of operation DDS runs every week in Malaysian and Indonesian waters. With Iran's blacklist now threatening any vessel that conducts an STS transfer with a listed tanker, the standard for counterparty screening in every STS job — not just Gulf-linked ones — has effectively been raised.

Market	Why It Matters This Week
Malaysia	Home to Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and the Johor STS/bunkering corridor. Iran's STS-contagion blacklist clause raises the bar on counterparty screening for every job here.
Singapore	Continues to anchor the region's bunkering and STS infrastructure; VLSFO here remains the reference price for our corridor.
Indonesia	Batam and Karimun remain active in STS and bunkering; outer port limits require continued enhanced due diligence.
Thailand	Gulf of Thailand distribution continues to benefit from trade diversion as a secondary regional routing option.
Vietnam	Growing product-import demand; a bellwether for intra-Asia clean tanker and MR patterns as CPP fixtures firm.

STS & Marine-Services Operating Standard

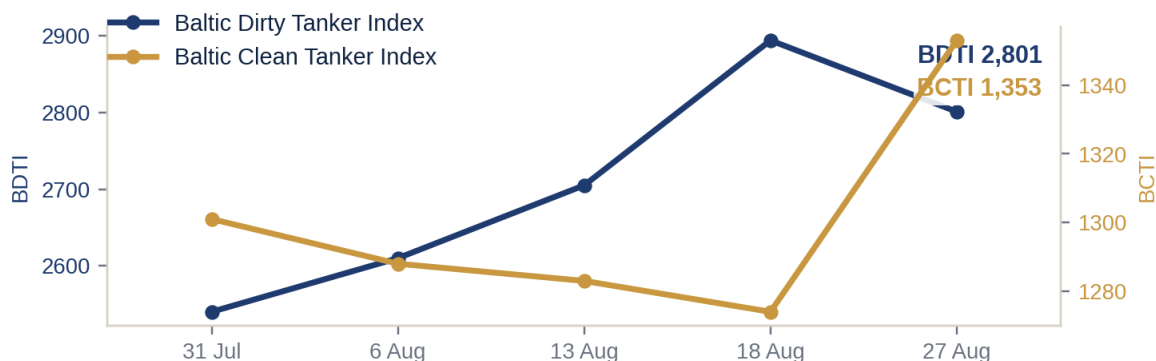
Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Counterparty & identity	IMO verification against scrapping records; beneficial ownership; AIS dark-period review; cargo-origin documentary chain; Iran blacklist check on both principals and STS counterparties.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

DDS VIEW — *The Gulf of Oman's covert STS activity is a reminder that ship-to-ship transfers are now a live sanctions and compliance surface, not just an operational one. Southeast Asia's STS volumes will keep growing as more tonnage avoids Hormuz; the premium this region commands depends entirely on our ability to show that our own STS execution is verifiably clean, end to end, counterparty included.*



Freight & Rate Signals

VLCC, Suezmax, Aframax and CPP fixtures — market reports circulated to DDS Marine, week of 1 September 2026



This chart carries over from Issue 005 for trend continuity; no confirmed Baltic Exchange print was available for this issue — see crude tanker methodology note.

Suezmax & Aframax Indicative Ranges (Tuesday, 1 September)

Route	Segment	Indicative Range
Fujairah / East	Suezmax, 130k	Ws350 level
AG / East (untested)	Suezmax, 130k	Ws700 level, basis owners' willingness
Red Sea / East (if Saudi loading)	Suezmax, 130k	Ws530 level
Bashayer / East	Suezmax, 130k	Ws375 level
Fujairah / West	Suezmax	Ws195 level
AG / Fujairah (to be tested)	Suezmax	US\$10–12m lump sum
Fujairah / East	Aframax, 80k	Ws330–340
AG / East (basis owners' willingness)	Aframax, 80k	Ws500+ level
Red Sea / East (untested, if Saudi loading)	Aframax, 80k	Ws500+ level
Bashayer / East (to be tested)	Aframax, 80k	Ws340–350

Selected VLCC Fixtures Reported

Vessel	Size	Route	Laycan	Rate / Status
Front Eira	270k	Fujairah/East	5–6 Sep	Ws242.5 — Petraco, 235k
Aphrodite	260k	Brazil/USWC	2–3 Oct	Ws230 — Petrobras, 225k
Morning Hope, Pinios, Zakum, Hercules I, Advantage Verity	270k	Fujairah (various)	3–8 Sep	On subs

Selected Suezmax Fixtures Reported

Vessel	Size	Route	Laycan	Rate / Status
Aegean Winner	135k	CPC/Med-UKC-Ningbo	14 Sep	Ws350–340 / ~US\$17m — Ineos
PTT	130k	WAF/East	17 Sep	Ws245 — Nordic Star
Sonangol Maiombe	130k	Brazil/WCI	23 Sep	Ws198 — Petro, 94k

Period / Time-Charter Market — TC Fixtures Reported, 3 September 2026

A distinct market from the spot fixtures above: charterers taking tonnage on time charter for a fixed daily rate over months or years, rather than a single voyage. Period activity is a leading indicator of how long the market expects current conditions to last.

Vessel	Size	Rate	Duration	Delivery	Charterer
VLCC					
New Odyssey	318k dwt	US\$75,000/day	3 years	East	Koch
Azumasan	302k dwt	US\$120,000/day	6 months	WAF	Clearlake
SUEZMAX					
Kapodistrias 21	158k dwt	US\$140,000/day	2 months	Med	Trafigura
Sonangol Huila	158k dwt	US\$105,000/day	6–9 months	UK-Cont	Trafigura
Sonangol Kulumbimbi	158k dwt	US\$94,000/day	12 months	UK-Cont	Mercuria
AFRAMAX					
Victory Venture	113k dwt	US\$60,000/day	12 months	USG	Exxon
LR2					
Priamos	113k dwt	US\$110,000/day	2 months	Ex yard	Trafigura
Copacabana	113k dwt	US\$95,000/day	3 months	Ex yard	Trafigura
Lyric Cameliia	110k dwt	US\$50,000/day	24 months	Gibraltar	Mercuria
Hafnia Despina	115k dwt	US\$50,000/day	24 months	Fos	Mercuria
Lyric Magnolia	110k dwt	Rate not reported	~3 months	East	Exxon
MR-2					
Nord Harmony	50k dwt	US\$29,000/day	12 months	East	Exxon
T Matterhorn (TBR)	48k dwt	US\$25,000/day	6 months	USG	Shell
SM Falcon	50k dwt	US\$25,500/day	24 months	WAF	Clearlake
Oriental Aquamarine	50k dwt	US\$31,500/day	2–4 months	Australia	Ampol
PS Hamburg	52k dwt	US\$22,500/day	5 years	ARA	ST Shipping
Wiltshire	49k dwt	US\$31,000/day	12–16 months	Ex yard	Stena
Seawitch	40k dwt	US\$32,000/day	12 months	USG	Suncor

MR-2 CHEMICAL

Stena Imagination	50k dwt	US\$27,750/day	24 months	UK-Cont	Essar
CL Marguerite Duras	50k dwt	US\$26,000/day	36 months	East	BP
CL Agathe Christie	50k dwt	US\$26,000/day	24 months	India DC	BP
CL Pearl Buck	50k dwt	US\$24,000/day	24 months	India DC	BP

MR-1

Stingray (25 Aug)	40k dwt	US\$24,000/day	3–6 months	UK-Cont	Clearlake
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DDS VIEW — period market: Two patterns stand out. First, the shortest Suezmax and LR2 deals are pricing in the crisis directly — Kapodistrias 21 fixed a 2-month Med TC to Trafigura at US\$140,000/day, and Priamos an ex-yard LR2 at US\$110,000/day for 2 months, both well above the equivalent multi-year levels on the same list. Second, and more telling for planning purposes, several charterers are committing well beyond the current crisis window regardless: BP has taken CL Marguerite Duras on a 36-month chemical MR deal, and ST Shipping has fixed PS Hamburg for 5 years. Multi-year commitments at today's elevated levels suggest at least some major charterers expect structurally firmer freight to persist well past any near-term resolution in Hormuz — not just a spike to be waited out.

DDS VIEW — The rate ranges above should be read as ranges, not points — several of the highest-quoted levels (AG/East Suezmax at Ws700, AG/East Aframax at Ws500+) remain untested by an actual fixture. Where a route shows both a quoted range and a confirmed fixture in the tables above, the confirmed fixture is the more reliable indication of where the market is actually clearing.

Seven-Day Outlook: 5 – 11 September 2026

5 – 11 September 2026

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Brent holding US\$90–100/bbl while active strikes continue and no negotiating framework exists.	Further strikes, a mining incident, or action toward Kharg Island pushing Brent through US\$100.	An unexpected ceasefire or verified de-escalation — no signal of either at present.
VLCC / Suezmax / Aframax	Firm-to-rising across all segments; owners quoting wide at the top end of Gulf-linked routes.	Further owner withdrawal from Hormuz tightening the willing pool and testing quoted highs (Ws500–700 levels).	A credible ceasefire prompting a rapid return of withheld tonnage.
War risk / insurance	Premiums holding at 3–6%+ of vessel value; cargo/STS cover increasingly complex to place.	Further tanker strikes pushing premiums higher still, particularly for the southern corridor.	Sustained quiet period allowing underwriters to ease terms.
Southeast Asia	Continued premium on Gulf/ Singapore routings; STS counterparty screening standard permanently raised by the blacklist.	Further redirected tonnage as Hormuz transits remain thin relative to claims.	A verified de-escalation reducing the diversion premium our region currently enjoys.

Watch List

- Whether the US follows through on threats to extend strikes toward Kharg Island, and how Iran responds if it does.
- Whether Kpler's Hormuz transit counts begin to close the gap with officially claimed volumes, or whether the gap widens further.
- Whether Iran acts on further blacklist threats, or extends the 45-vessel list following additional STS activity.
- P&I club and war-risk underwriter guidance following the Senegal Prosperity and Sidr incidents.
- Whether hardline calls to target subsea fibre-optic cables in the Gulf translate into any actual incident.

DDS CONCLUSION — Issue 005 recorded the first tentative steps toward de-escalation. Issue 006 records how quickly that window closed: strikes on Larak Island, missiles on Jordan and the UAE, two tankers hit within a day, and a blacklist that now reaches into ship-to-ship operations directly relevant to our own business. The most important discipline for the week ahead is not predicting the next headline but refusing to plan around the announced numbers when the tracked numbers say something very different.

Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

ISSUE 006

DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence combines public market data, official regulatory releases, reputable news reporting and operator-focused analysis. Freight commentary is directional and does not reproduce proprietary broker assessments or subscription-only indices. Where no confirmed index print was available this issue, rates are presented as ranges per standard market practice.

Source	Information Used
oilprice.com / Trading Economics, 2 Sep 2026	Brent US\$94.86/bbl, WTI US\$90.72/bbl; coverage of the Larak Island strikes and subsequent retaliation.
Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 1–3 Sep 2026	Singapore, Fujairah, Rotterdam, Houston, Hong Kong, Santos, LA/Long Beach and New York VLSFO/MGO/IFO380 indications; regional averages; EUA compliance costs; oil price daily series.
Hellenic Shipping News Worldwide, 1–3 Sep 2026	“Ship Recycling Market Retains Positive Momentum” (source: Best Oasis, Intermodal); weekly demolition and vessel valuation reports.
Wire reporting via named outlets (Reuters, RFE/RL, NPR, CBS, CNN)	Larak Island strikes and Iranian retaliation; Senegal Prosperity and Sidr incidents; Hormuz traffic claims vs. Kpler-tracked data; Iran’s 45-vessel blacklist.
Market fixture reports circulated to DDS Marine, 1–3 Sep 2026	VLCC, Suezmax, Aframax and CPP fixture and rate-range data for the Arabian Gulf, India, Southeast Asia and North Asia.

What's changed since Issue 005 (28 August 2026): The pause reported in Issue 005 ended on 30 August, when the US struck Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island and Iran retaliated with missiles against bases in Jordan and the UAE. The supertanker Senegal Prosperity was struck by naval mines and the Sidr by projectiles on 31 August, both inside the Strait’s southern corridor. Iran has blacklisted 45 tankers linked to ADNOC L&S, Navig8 and Bahri, and now threatens STS counterparties of listed vessels. Brent has risen from US\$88.57 to US\$94.86 and Singapore VLSFO from US\$781.00 to US\$838.00/mt. DDS’s risk assessment has been raised from ELEVATED back to CRITICAL.

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Maritime Intelligence | STS Operations | Marine Advisory | Energy Solutions
ISSUE 006 — 4 SEPTEMBER 2026 | Prepared for professional circulation | Malaysia / Southeast Asia focus